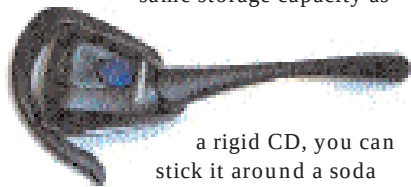


Showstoppers at CeBIT 2002

CeBIT 2002 saw a lot of hot new products and technologies. Take for example the flexCD, which is the first physically flexible CD on the planet. With the same storage capacity as



a rigid CD, you can stick it around a soda can like a sticker, or even wrap it around pencils.

Plantronics announced

the future of speech communications by releasing M1500, its first Bluetooth headset for a wide range of mobile phones.

Toshiba unveiled its new European GPRS i-mode phone, the TS21i, which features a large, colour screen and high-speed data access using GPRS.

Roxio previewed a technology code-named 'Hitchcock', which has been developed to combine CD and DVD recording into one integrated, easy-to-use application.



Other high-profile launches included Transmeta's Midori Linux for mobile devices. And for all car lovers, IBM sponsored the Smart car while Fujitsu Siemens featured the Mini.

redalert

Klez resurfaces

Klez, the worm, which was spreading via e-mail, has now become a menace. Documents, spreadsheets and other graphic images are vulnerable to attack. The worm gets activated on the 6th of every odd-numbered month. It can cause extensive damage that can wipe your hard disk clean. The virus reaches your mailbox with a subject and body that comprise a lengthy string of random text within which the virus incubates. When activated, the virus copies a file that bears the name Wink followed by some random characters and ends with a .exe extension. As a protective measure, you can carry out a search for this file and delete it from your computer. Also run a thorough virus check after updating your virus database. The virus spreads through a security hole in Outlook. Get the Patch at www.microsoft.com.

Sharpei hits .NET

A new virus, Sharpei, based on C# is on the prowl. It targets .exe files on the .NET platform and spreads via e-mail. This is more or less similar to the earlier 'Donut' virus genre. It is one of those slippery viruses that e-mail themselves as a 'Windows update'. The subject line is quite convincing—it states that the sender has tried and tested the attachment. Once opened, the virus mails itself to all contacts in your Outlook and even removes traces of itself from the sent folder and the inbox.

All major anti-virus manufacturers have issued patches for Sharpei detection and control.

You've got MTNL

MTNL Internet and phone subscribers can now be notified via phone every time they receive a new mail. The system works on a text to voice scheme. You can check your mail on the phone, hear the subject of the message, the name of the sender and even the content of the



e-mail, if you so wish. The MTNL e-mail-to-phone system, based on unified messaging service capabilities, can handle 2.1 lakh subscribers simultaneously. The service can be made available to both fixed line as well as cellular subscribers of MTNL, and is scheduled to become operational in the first half of the year 2002.

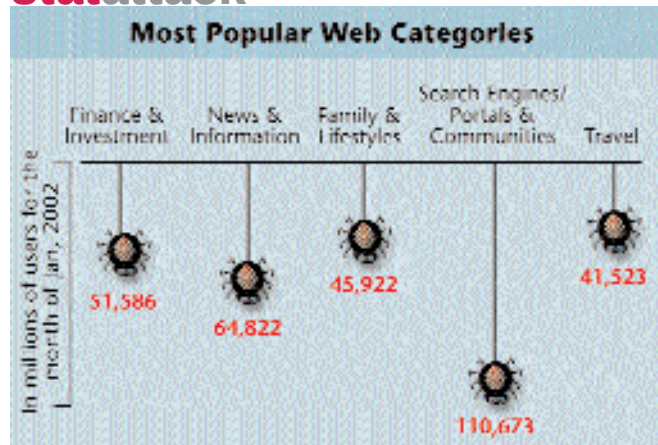
Slash the ads

Slashdot.org will put up larger ads and place a premium on ad-free pages. A note on the site from co-founder CmdrTaco said, "We don't have an option; these are what advertisers want, and if we don't provide them, we won't be around much longer. But we want to give you an option to see Slashdot without these ads." The site will also offer subscribers an inventive way to avoid ads—pay \$5 for every 1,000 ad-free pages.

PC games: Not dead as yet

Microsoft revealed its PC game plans through next year with the release of the Xbox. Upcoming titles include *Rise of Nations*, an empire-building game similar to the popular *Civilization* series, and *Age of Mythology* a strategy game based on the *Age of Empires* series. Other AAA titles expected this year are *Combat Flight Simulator III*, *Asheron's Call II*, *Zoo Tycoon: Dinosaur Digs* and *Links 2003*.

statattack



Source: www.nielsen-netratings.com

■ AMD unveils 1.73 GHz Athlon XP 2100+ processor ■ Siemens releases M50 Java enabled MMS phones ■ Intel gives the green signal to HP-Compaq